



9th Edition · Best of JS Curated

# 2024 JavaScript Rising Stars

Top Projects and Ecosystem Shifts

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Methodology: [GitHub stars added Jan-Dec 2024](#)

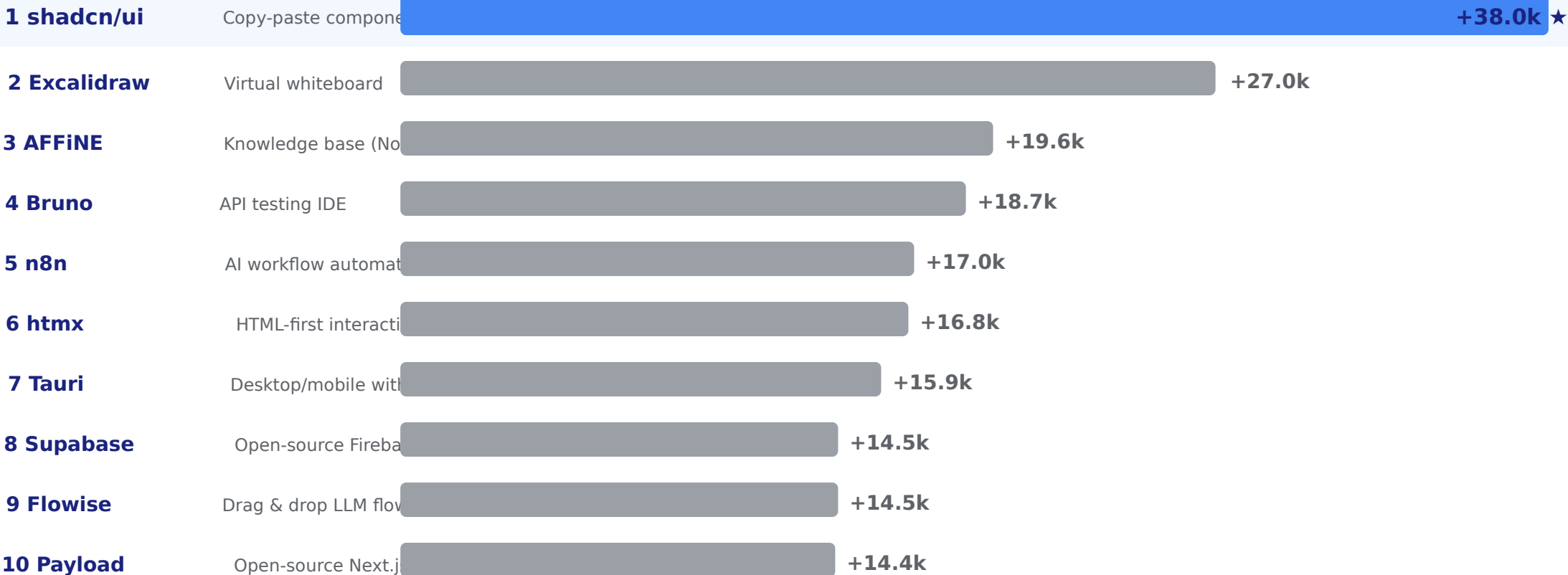
For Frontend Engineers & Engineering Managers

April 2026 · [risingstars.js.org/2024](https://risingstars.js.org/2024)



# shadcn/ui Leads Overall with +38k Stars, Followed by Excalidraw and AFFiNE

9th edition of JavaScript Rising Stars · GitHub stars added Jan-Dec 2024 · Curated by Best of JS



+11k gap vs #2



**shadcn/ui dominates with a commanding +11k lead over #2 Excalidraw**

4 of the top 10 projects (n8n, Flowise, Supabase, AFFiNE) have significant AI capabilities



# shadcn/ui: Copy-Paste Components Win for the Second Consecutive Year



Total Stars

77.5k



#1 Rank

2 Years

Consecutive #1 Overall

## Stars Added Year-over-Year



Created Jan 2023 · Extraordinary back-to-back momentum

Only -3.9% YoY drop — exceptional retention of momentum

## Key 2024 Features & Highlights

1

### Charts

Powered by Recharts; integrated data visualization components

2

### Themes

CSS variable generation for complete design systems

3

### Blocks

Layout collections for typical web app patterns

4

### Sidebar

New responsive sidebar component

5

### CLI Upgrades

Supports Next.js, Remix, Vite, Laravel & monorepos  
Installs components, themes, hooks, utils, dependencies

6

### Registry Ecosystem

Import from any compatible registry; spawned Motion-Primitives, Magic UI

7

### Vercel v0 Integration

AI-generated components via Vercel's v0 service drove further adoption

## Why shadcn/ui wins: developers own the code

Copy-paste model → full control, no import lock-in, customizable to any design system  
The registry ecosystem has become a platform, not just a component library

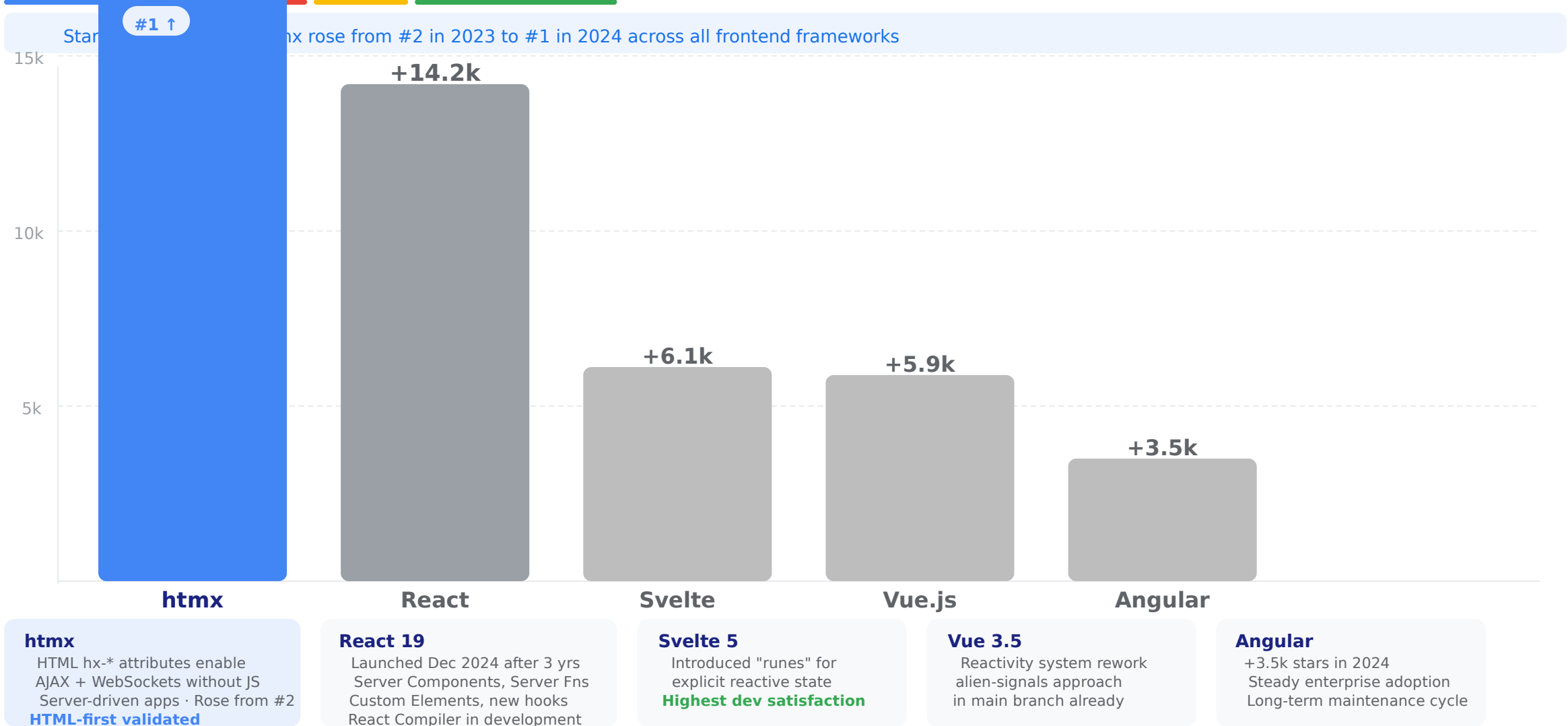


## 2024 Monthly Peak

January 2024: +7.3k stars in one month · Sustained 2-3k/month throughout the year



# htmx Overtakes React as #1 Front-end Framework by Stars Added



**Key Insight:** htmx validates HTML-first, low-JavaScript architectures for server-driven applications  
React's lead shrinks — not from decline, but from htmx's surge in a previously underserved architectural niche



# React Ecosystem: shadcn/ui, Excalidraw, and Payload Dominate

## React 19: Three Years in the Making

- ✓ **Launched December 2024 after 3 years of development**
- ✓ **Server Components & Server Functions**  
Full-stack primitives enabling seamless client-server data flow
- ✓ **Web Component (Custom Elements) Support**  
Interoperability with the web platform's native component model
- ✓ **New Hooks & Form Actions**  
useOptimistic, useFormStatus, useActionState and more
- ✓ **React Compiler (active development)**  
Auto-memoization, improved DX and performance

### "React is becoming a specification for frameworks"

— Robin Wieruch

Next.js, Remix, and others interpret React's primitives differently, making React more of a specification than a standalone library



### React ecosystem: still allows client-only usage

SPA-first teams: no migration required — React 19 is additive

## React Ecosystem Top 5 — Stars Added 2024

### shadcn/ui

Copy-paste components

+38.0k

### Excalidraw

Virtual whiteboard

+27.0k

### Payload

Fullstack Next.js CMS framework

+14.4k

### Magic UI

shadcn-inspired component library

+13.2k

### Next.js

React framework for production

+12.1k

### Observation: shadcn/ui is the #1 React project —

even though it's not a "React-only" library. Its framework-agnostic design echoes React's own "spec over library" evolution.

# Vue Ecosystem Flourishes: Nuxt, PrimeVue, and Slidev Lead Growth

## Vue 3.5: Reactivity Overhaul

- ✓ **Reactivity system reworked from the ground up**  
Improved performance and memory efficiency across the board
- ✓ **alien-signals: lighter reactive primitives**  
Already landing in Vue's main branch for Vue core
- ✓ **Active release cycle, regular performance improvements**  
— Daniel Roe, Nuxt core team lead
- ✓ **Flourishing UI library ecosystem**  
PrimeVue, shadcn-vue signal growing ecosystem confidence

**A wave of high-quality UI libraries signals**  
a confident, maturing Vue ecosystem

Vue is no longer "the React alternative" — it's a first-class ecosystem choice

## Project Spotlights

### Nuxt

Vue's Next.js — SSR,  
SSG & full-stack

**+6.2k**

### PrimeVue

Rich component library  
enterprise-grade UI

**+5.4k**

### Slidev

Markdown-powered  
slides for devs

**+4.7k**

## Vue Ecosystem Top 5 — Stars Added 2024

### Nuxt

Vue's production framework

**+6.2k**

### PrimeVue

Enterprise component library

**+5.4k**

### Slidev

Dev-centric Markdown slides

**+4.7k**

### shadcn-vue

Vue port of shadcn/ui

**+4.1k**

### VitePress

Static site generator for docs

**+3.7k**



### Context: Vue projects trend lower in absolute stars vs React

React has ~3x larger global community. Vue's growth is driven by quality, not hype — a sign of disciplined ecosystem maturation rather than viral adoption.

# AI Tools, Desktop Apps, and Browser-Based Innovation Shape 2024

Three cross-cutting themes emerged beyond the framework rankings · all point toward where JS is heading in 2025



## AI-Powered Projects

4 of top 10 overall

+17.0k

Fair-code workflow automation  
with native AI integrations  
Ranked #5 overall

+14.5ke

Drag & drop UI to build custom  
LLM flows and chatbots  
Ranked #9 overall

+14.5kase

Open-source Firebase alternative  
with AI-ready vector search  
Ranked #8 overall

### AI integration = table stakes

Developers expect AI-native workflows  
in their tooling and platforms



## Desktop & Mobile Apps

Web tech goes native

+15.9k

Desktop & mobile apps with web  
frontend, Rust backend

- Significantly lighter than Electron
- Small binary size, lower memory use

Ranked #7 overall

### Why it matters for frontend teams

Web developers can now target desktop  
and mobile with their existing skills  
React / Vue / Svelte → Tauri app  
Single codebase, multiple platforms

### Web tech continues native push

Tauri's momentum = Electron disruption  
Watch: Tauri 2.0 mobile targets



## Browser Innovation

WASM expands boundaries

WASM

Full Postgres running via  
WebAssembly in the browser

- Persistent data without a server
- Local-first application architecture

In-browser VM

Full virtual machine running  
entirely in the browser tab

- Run Linux programs, no install
- WASM enabling server-side tasks

### Browser = New platform tier

WASM enables workloads previously  
impossible client-side. Offline-first,  
local-first apps become viable.

### Common thread:

JavaScript ecosystem is expanding its attack surface — AI, native desktop, and server-in-browser are all in scope for 2025



# Key Takeaways: What 2024 Tells Us About JavaScript's Future

1

## Component ownership beats imports

shadcn/ui's copy-paste model won for a second year — developers want to own and customize their component code. 77.5k total stars prove this model has staying power. The registry ecosystem has become a platform.



2

## HTML-first is serious architecture

htmx (+16.8k) overtook React as the #1 front-end framework by stars. Server-driven, low-JS architectures are validated. This is not a niche preference — it signals a real architectural divergence in the JS ecosystem.

3

## React is becoming a framework specification

React 19 delivers Server Components & Server Functions. Next.js, Remix interpret React's primitives differently. React is evolving from a UI library into a specification that frameworks implement — a paradigm shift.

4

## AI integration is now table stakes

4 of the top 10 projects (n8n, Flowise, Supabase, AFFiNE) have significant AI capabilities. AI is no longer a feature — it's expected infrastructure. Projects without AI hooks will feel dated.

5

## Vue's ecosystem maturity is here

High-quality UI libraries (PrimeVue, shadcn-vue) + Vue 3.5 reactivity overhaul signal a confident ecosystem. Vue is a mature, production-first choice — not just a React alternative anymore.



## Heading into 2025: Watch AI-native tooling, WASM-powered browser workloads,

Tauri 2.0 mobile targets, the React-as-specification shift, and continued shadcn/ui ecosystem expansion

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